



INDUSTRY BRIEF · HOME SERVICES

The hour around the job

Where a small home-services business leaks money and time, what it adds up to, and how to tell which fix is worth it.

\$5,250

a month, plus about five hours of the owner's week, for one typical three-person shop. Page 5 shows the math. Page 6 lets you run yours.

Illustrative shop, modelled from published figures and conservative assumptions. Not a client result.

MPW Consulting

Prepared for owners and operators
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mpwconsulting.ca

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01 · THE SHORT VERSION

The leak is the hour around the job.

The work on site is rarely the problem. The problem is the hour before it and the hour after it: the call nobody took, the quote nobody chased, and the invoices, schedules and reminders that wait until after dinner. That hour costs you in two ways.

Revenue that walks away

MONEY IN

1 in 7

calls go unanswered in home services, and up to 85% of those callers never try again. ²

11–15%

of revenue at many larger contractors comes from following up on quotes that went quiet. ¹

3 options

on the quote is how top performers price at least half their jobs. Struggling ones almost never do. ¹

Hours that disappear

TIME AND COST

Evenings

Quotes, invoices and scheduling get done at the kitchen table, because the day belongs to the job.

Chasing

Overdue invoices mean calls and texts you don't bill for, and cash that sits in someone else's account.

No-shows

A missed appointment is a truck roll you pay for: fuel, wages and a slot you could have filled.

Time back counts as much as a new job.

Four hours a week you don't spend on admin is four hours on paid work, or at home.

Faster only helps if you can do the work.

If the board is full, more calls won't help. Then the fix is on the cost side.

Most shops have one big leak.

You don't need six fixes. You need the one that cost you most last month.

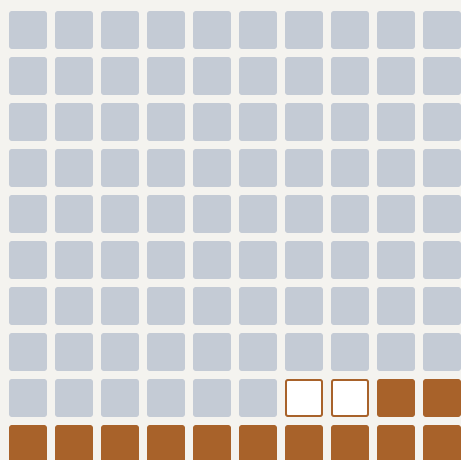
THE RULE

Find the biggest leak before you fix anything. If none of them is big, don't build anything. That's a fine answer.

02 · WHERE THE WEEK LEAKS

Every 100 calls, about 14 go nowhere.

The phone is the easiest leak to see, so start there. It is one of six, and three of the six are about time rather than sales.



86 answered

Out of every 100 calls to a home-services business.²

14 missed

You were on a roof, under a sink or driving.

Up to 12 gone

They call the next company on the list, and that company answers.²

THE LEAK

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

REVENUE

The missed call

You call back at 4pm. They booked someone at 10.

A job you already paid to make the phone ring.

The quiet quote

You meant to follow up. Two weeks went by.

A sale that was half done. They hired whoever followed up.

The lapsed customer

The tune-up list lives in your head.

Easy repeat work from people who already trust you.

TIME AND COST

Evening admin

Quotes and invoices at 9pm, after the kids are down.

Hours every week, and quotes that go out a day late.

Chasing payment

"Did they pay?" is still on the list on Friday.

Unbilled calls and texts, and cash you've earned but can't use.

No-shows

You drive 30 minutes to a locked door.

Fuel, wages and a slot you could have given someone else.

03 · WHAT THE FIX LOOKS LIKE

Small fixes, on tools you already have.

Each fix sits on your phone or your job software. You still set the price, own the schedule and talk to the customer. The last column is the number that tells you it's working.

THE LEAK	WITH THE FIX	WHAT STAYS YOURS	NUMBER TO WATCH
REVENUE			
Missed call	→ A text goes out the minute you miss it: "On a job, can I call you at 2? Or book here."	You make the call back.	Missed calls answered within 5 minutes
Quiet quote	→ Follow-ups on day 2, 5 and 10. They stop when the customer books or says no.	You set the price.	Quotes with a yes or no in 14 days
Lapsed customer	→ A reminder goes out the month each visit is due, with a link to book.	You own the calendar.	Due customers who booked
TIME AND COST			
Evening admin	→ Quotes start as drafts with your good / better / best options filled in. Invoices go out when the job closes.	You check and hit send.	Hours a week on admin
Chasing payment	→ Polite reminders at 7, 14 and 21 days, with a pay link.	You decide when to call.	Average days to get paid
No-shows	→ A confirmation the day before and a heads-up when you're on the way.	You decide the policy.	Wasted trips a month

Which one first?

The board has gaps

Start with missed calls or quiet quotes. More of the work you already paid to attract.

The board is full

Don't build a faster phone. You'd book work you can't staff. Start with evening admin and get your hours back.

Slow season is coming

Start with lapsed customers. Fill the calendar from people who already know you.

04 · WHAT IT ADDS UP TO

One small shop, worked through.

A three-person plumbing company: the owner and two techs. Every percentage below is deliberately conservative, well under the research, so treat the result as a floor.

3 people, 2 trucks	~35 calls a week	\$400 average service call	\$2,500 average quoted job	10 hrs owner admin a week
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Revenue that walks away

Missed calls **\$25,000**

5 a week · × 25% won back × \$400 × 50 weeks

Quiet quotes **\$18,000**

6 a month · × 10% extra close × \$2,500 × 12

Lapsed customers **\$4,050**

150 due a visit · × 15% extra booked × \$180

Revenue recovered **\$47,050**

Hours that disappear

Evening admin **\$12,000**

10 hrs a week · × 40% handled × \$60/hr × 50 weeks = 200 hrs

Chasing payment **\$2,160**

10 overdue a month · × 30 min × 60% fewer chases × \$60 × 12 = 36 hrs

No-shows **\$1,800**

3 a month · × 40% prevented × \$125 a wasted trip × 12

Time and cost saved **\$15,960**

PER MONTH

\$5,250

OWNER TIME BACK

~5 hrs/wk

About \$63,000 a year in total, and roughly 236 hours. That's six working weeks the owner no longer spends on admin.

Where this shop starts

Missed calls, if the board has room. It's the biggest number and the quickest to set up.

If the board were full

Evening admin. Five hours a week back is what a part-time hire would give you, without the hire.

What we didn't count

Reviews, faster payment and quotes sent a day sooner. All real, all left out.

Illustrative example. The shop profile and results are modelled from the figures cited on page 8 and the assumptions shown. They are not a specific client's results. Your numbers will differ, which is what page 6 is for.

05 · SIZE YOUR OWN

Ten minutes, rough numbers.

Fill in the blanks from last month. The printed percentages are the same conservative ones used on page 5.

REVENUE THAT WALKS AWAY

Missed calls	<u> </u> Calls missed a week	× 25% Won back by a text	× \$ <u> </u> Average job	× 50 Weeks	= \$ <u> </u> A · a year
Quiet quotes	<u> </u> Quiet quotes a month	× 10% Extra that close	× \$ <u> </u> Average quote	× 12 Months	= \$ <u> </u> B · a year
Lapsed customers	<u> </u> Due a visit a year	× 15% Extra who book	× \$ <u> </u> Average visit		= \$ <u> </u> C · a year

HOURS THAT DISAPPEAR

Evening admin	<u> </u> Admin hours a week	× 40% Handled for you	× \$ <u> </u> Your hourly value	× 50 Weeks	= \$ <u> </u> D · a year
Chasing payment	<u> </u> Overdue invoices a month	× 0.3 hr Hours saved per invoice	× \$ <u> </u> Your hourly value	× 12 Months	= \$ <u> </u> E · a year
No-shows	<u> </u> Wasted trips a month	× 40% Prevented	× \$ <u> </u> Cost of a wasted trip	× 12 Months	= \$ <u> </u> F · a year

A + B + C · REVENUE

D + E + F · TIME AND COST

BIGGEST SINGLE LINE: START HERE

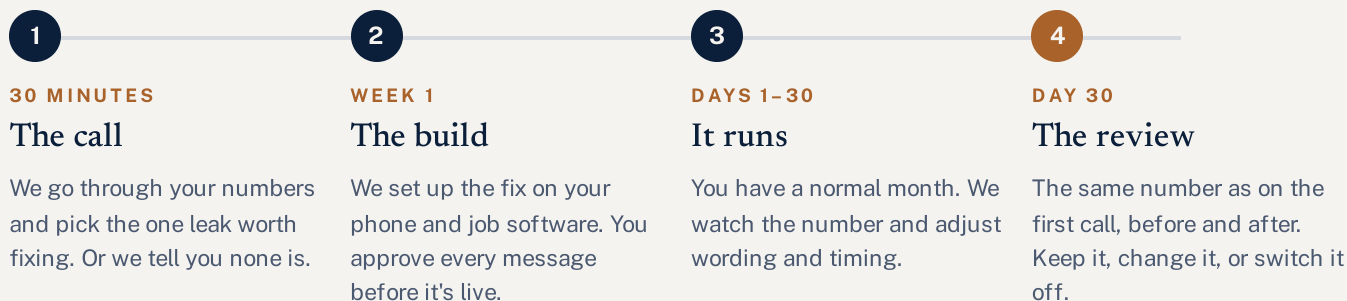
Prefer to click? The online calculator does the math, has presets for your shop size, and ranks your leaks.

mpwconsulting.ca/calculator

06 · HOW WE WORK

One leak, one fix, one number.

No platform, no bundle. We find the leak your numbers support, build that one fix on the tools you already have, and show you whether it worked.



What you can count on

- A fixed scope and price, agreed before we build anything.
- One fix at a time. We only add a second if the first one paid.
- Messages go out from your business, in your words.
- You own the setup. Nothing is locked to us.
- If the number doesn't move, we say so at day 30.

Questions owners ask

Will customers know it's automated?

The messages are short and sound like you. Most read like something you'd send yourself if you had a free minute.

We already pay for job software.

Good. We build on top of it wherever it allows, so there's no new app for your team to learn.

How soon will we see a difference?

Most fixes are live within the first week. The day-30 review shows the before and after on your own numbers.



MPW Consulting builds automation for owner-run service businesses in Toronto and Waterloo. We sit with you, look at your actual week, and build the one thing your numbers support.

07 · NEXT STEP

We'll look at your week, not the industry.

Thirty minutes. If nothing is big enough to fix, we'll say so.

BOOK A CALL

Thirty minutes, on your schedule

Early morning or after the last job, whatever works around your trucks.

mpwconsulting.ca/contact

EMAIL

hello@mpwconsulting.ca

WEB

mpwconsulting.ca

CALCULATOR

mpwconsulting.ca/calculator

WHAT TO BRING (ANY OF THESE HELPS, NONE IS REQUIRED)

Your worksheet

Page 6 filled in, or a screenshot of the online calculator.

Last week's call log

Straight from your phone or phone system.

Open quotes and invoices

An export or a screenshot from your job software is plenty.

WHERE THE FIGURES COME FROM

1. ServiceTitan, 2025. Survey of more than 1,000 U.S. residential contractors: estimate follow-up (11-15% of revenue at many larger contractors) and three-option quoting.

Assumptions. The percentages on pages 5 and 6 (25%, 10%, 15%, 40%, 60%) are MPW's conservative working assumptions, not research findings. We check them against your records on the first call.

2. CallRail, January 2025. Across 1.1 million home-services conversations, about 14% of calls were missed. Up to 85% of unanswered callers do not call back.

A note on Canada. Sources 1 and 2 are U.S. studies. We expect GTA shops to be similar, which is why the worksheet uses your own numbers.